

DEFINING MARRIAGE

* Blue denotes PPT slide

* Brown denotes instructions to technician

A few days ago, the supreme Court of the United States of America handed down a ruling that they say changed the definition of marriage. As your pastor, I feel the weight of responsibility to tell you where I stand and where this church stands on this very important issue.

As a Christian, I am supposed to emulate Jesus, and as a church our response must first and foremost be Christ like. So that statement begs an explanation of how I believe Jesus would respond. [John 1:14 \(NKJV\)](#) ***"The Word became flesh and dwelt among us, and we beheld His glory, the glory as of the only begotten of the Father, full of grace and truth."*** If we as Christians

and a church are going to be Christ like we must do two things:

- Handle the issue and the people affected by it with grace...
- Speak truth to the issue and the individuals who are affected by it...

As I address this issue over the next few weeks, I intend to allow those two guiding principles to guard my thoughts and choose my words.

First of all, we are all God's creation whether our choices have led us to be heterosexual, bisexual, homosexual, transgendered, etc... All of us are God's creation; some are not God's children. Being a child of God has to do with a choice to follow Him and live according to the parameters of His Word.

At the forefront of this issue, Christians must keep at the forefront of their minds that

everyone has an eternal soul and we are in the business of leading people from the darkness of this world into the light of the Gospel. We cannot lead people from where they are to where they need to be if we engage in name-calling and hateful speech or actions.

In this series I want to focus on three questions:

- Who has the right to define marriage?
- What does this mean for America?
- What should the response of the church be?

WHO HAS THE RIGHT TO DEFINE MARRIAGE? (LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)

First of all, let me say that the five judges who spoke for more than three hundred million Americans are a part of the Supreme Court, but they will eventually answer to a Sovereign court. There is not enough money

in the world for me to volunteer to change places with any of those five justices. They are not accountable to the American people, but they are accountable to God.

The governments of this world:

- Did not create marriage...
- Do not own marriage...
- Cannot define marriage...
- Have no authority to redefine marriage...

Marriage was created by God and pre-dates the church and the state. If marriage came from the mind of God and was instituted by Him, what government or court has the authority to define or redefine it?

Where did marriage start? [Genesis 1:26-28 \(NKJV\)](#) “***And God said, Let us make man in our image, after our likeness: and let them have dominion over the fish of the sea, and over the fowl of the air, and over***

the cattle, and over all the earth, and over every creeping thing that creepeth upon the earth.²⁷ So God created man in his own image, in the image of God created he him; male and female created he them.²⁸ And God blessed them, and God said unto them, Be fruitful, and multiply, and replenish the earth, and subdue it: and have dominion over the fish of the sea, and over the fowl of the air, and over every living thing that moveth upon the earth.

(LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL END OF THE FOLLOWING BULLET POINTS)

This passage points out the following things:

- Humankind is created in the image of God...
- God created humankind male and female...
- God gave a man and a woman the power to procreate...
- God gave humankind authority over all creation...

I want us to take a closer look at these verses. The creation of both man and woman happened on the sixth day of creation. The Lord rested on the seventh day, and listen to what [Genesis 2:7 \(NKJV\)](#) has to say. ***“The LORD God formed man of the dust of the ground, and breathed into his nostrils the breath of life; and man became a living being”*** Wait a second! God created man, male and female on the sixth day of creation and now following the seventh day of creation God actually forms man from the dust of the ground and breathes into his nostrils the breath of life, and man became a living soul. At this point there is no mention of the woman that God created in chapter one when He created the man! Hang with me now!

Later in chapter two we read this. [Genesis 2:18 \(NKJV\)](#) ***“God said, “It is not good that man should be alone; I will make him a helper comparable to him.”*** [Genesis 2:21-](#)

24 (NKJV) *“The LORD God caused a deep sleep to fall on Adam, and he slept; and He took one of his ribs, and closed up the flesh in its place. ²² Then the rib which the LORD God had taken from man He made into a woman, and He brought her to the man. ²³ And Adam said: “This is now bone of my bones and flesh of my flesh; She shall be called Woman, Because she was taken out of Man.”²⁴ Therefore a man shall leave his father and mother and be joined to his wife, and they shall become one flesh.”*

Here is what we learn from these verses:

- God created the man and the woman in chapter one...
- In chapter two He created the man from the dust of the earth...
- In chapter two He created the woman using a piece of the man to do so...

What is going on here? I believe this is what happened:

- On the sixth day the woman and man was created in the mind of God... (Telescopic)
- In chapter two, following the seventh day, He formed man using the dust of the ground... (Microscopic)
- Later He took the woman from the flesh of the man rather than from the ground... (Microscopic)

Marriage was created in the mind of God before a human being was ever formed. As a result, marriage was the vehicle created by God to properly carry out family relationships.

This I know:

- Man was made in the image of God and can never be complete without an intimate relationship with Him... A part of God is in us and when extracted it leaves in its wake a feeling of dissatisfaction.

- The woman was taken from the flesh of the man and when there is true intimacy between a man and a woman that are committed Christians, a feeling of completion is developed...

CONCLUSION:

God created marriage:

- Before He rested...
- Before a person was created...
- Before there was a church...
- Before there was a government...

If this is true, and I have proven it scripturally, does the Supreme Court have the right to define or redefine marriage? No! A thousand times no!

Marriage never belonged to the state; it belongs to God. The only people who are truly married are the ones that God recognizes. The state and the federal

government should never have been in the marriage business to start with.

Just because the Supreme Court says something does not make it a fact. Sure they can recognize a union with a piece of paper that says “*Marriage License*,” but the only legitimate marriages are sanctioned in Heaven and recognized by God.

WHAT DOES THIS MEAN FOR AMERICA? (LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)

This decision will bring about so many results that it would be impossible to list them all.

Focus On The Family lists nine results on their website: **(PLACE ON SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

1) Harms Children... Redefining marriage denies children of same-sex couples either a mother or a father. Decades of social science

research shows children do best when they're raised in a home with their married mom and dad. Government policies should reflect the benefits of both a mom and a dad.

2) Forced Closures... Faith-based adoption agencies will be forced to close their doors when faced with laws and mandates requiring them to violate their religious beliefs by placing children in homes with same-sex parents. This pressure will increase in the coming days.

3) Legal/Public Challenges... Christian business owners – photographers, bakers, inn keepers, florists and others – who politely decline to use their talents and businesses to participate in same-sex ceremonies, will experience harassment, legal challenges and crippling fines.

4) Parental Rights... Parents who want a say in what their young children are being taught in school about homosexuality will discover legalized same-sex marriage to be a

"trump card" that will override their parental rights, leaving them no say in the matter.

5) Tax-Exempt Status... Pastors and churches will eventually face pressure to perform and celebrate same-sex marriages or face government retribution, such as the loss of tax-exempt status, or possibly be prosecuted for discrimination.

6) Accrediting/Licensing... Private religious school accreditation, professional licenses, and even employment criteria will require affirmation of homosexuality and same-sex marriage as a condition for approval.

7) Counseling... There will be a continued push to ban counseling for teenagers who struggle with unwanted same-sex attractions, and who desire therapy to address this.

8) Grant Exclusions... Faith-based charities that adhere to God's design for sexuality, marriage, and family, will be excluded from government grants that help serve the poor and needy at home and abroad.

9) Endangered Freedoms... Freedom of speech will become endangered as the government passes regulatory and even criminal laws punishing Christian views of marriage, deeming it as "hate speech" in any type of media, including radio, print, television, and the Web. This is already the case in Canada and the U.K.

Those who adhere to a biblical view of sexuality, marriage and family will need to increase their efforts to share this truth with love, as opponents of God's design push to silence and penalize supporters of one-man, one-woman marriage.

I believe America is about to see the judgment of God as a result of:

- Abortion...
- No prayer in schools...
- No Bible reading in schools...
- Kicking God out of the public sector...
- Abandoning the nation of Israel...

- The perversion that is being allowed through the Internet and Hollywood...
- The Supreme Court decision to legalize gay marriage...

While I do not disagree with the assessment of Focus On The Family, **these are my predictions for America: (PLACE ON SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- We will see a dip in the economy of this nation that will be unprecedented...
- We will see natural disasters like never before...
- We will see the crime rate rise to unprecedented levels...
- We will see rioting in the streets like never before...
- We will see terrorist acts being carried out within our geographical borders...
- The federal government will attempt to take all weapons away from its citizenry...

- We will see ministers persecuted and imprisoned...
- We will see Bible publishers being sued for publishing Bible verses that speak out against homosexuality...
- We will see the soon return of Jesus...

CONCLUSION:

The reason all these things will come to pass is that our nation has not only decided to exclude the very God and the values of the people who made it great, we have made a conscious decision to go against His written word. Breaking His commandments has become so normal that very few people even raise an eyebrow to sin.

My hope is that this decision will at last awaken the church and cause God's people to pray again.

There is hope! The only hope for this nation is for the church to return to the God they

are supposed to be serving and once again embrace His laws and commandments!

**WHAT SHOULD THE RESPONSE OF
THE CHURCH BE? (LEAVE ON
SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)**

As a Christian, I am supposed to emulate Jesus and as a church our response must first and foremost be Christ like. So that statement begs an explanation of how I believe Jesus would respond. [John 1:14](#)

[\(NKJV\) “*The Word became flesh and dwelt among us, and we beheld His glory, the glory as of the only begotten of the Father, full of grace and truth.*”](#) If we as Christians and a church are going to be Christ like, we must do two things:

- Handle the issues of our day and the people affected by them with grace...
- Speak truth to the issues and the individuals who are affected by them...

In short: We MUST love the lost and speak the truth with grace.

THE TRUTH:

How do we respond to people who say that they were born gay? If this is the case every child in the nursery is heterosexual or homosexual right now! They are neither, they are male and female and their sexuality will be defined by:

- The things that will happen to them...
- Patterns of behavior that are enforced upon them through their family of origin...
- The choices they will make...

The simple truth is this – we were all born with a seed of sin within us, and a natural propensity toward all kinds of evil. (Paul said it rises to the level of a war within)

It is true that we are all natural born sinners but we are not born bank robbers, liars,

thieves, cheaters, adulterers, or homosexuals.

Some would say that in our DNA we have a propensity to have heart disease, high blood pressure, diabetes etc... This is absolutely true but we are not born with an abnormal sexual attraction. The difference is, the health issues are a sickness the other is sinful behavior.

It is a scientific fact that wrongdoing changes brain chemistry. The cingulated cortex of our brain is where our will power comes from. This is where ethics and morals are decided. Scientists say that the cingulated cortex can be impacted by the use of alcohol, drugs, and viewing pornography. Here is how this works: The use of alcohol and viewing pornography changes the cingulated cortex and the altered cingulated cortex changes our behavior. Continued use of alcohol, drugs, and pornography

continues changing the cingulated cortex and the altered cingulated cortex continues changing our behavior. This is why those who go down the road of perversion find themselves not being able to be satisfied unless they continue to spiral into more and more demented behavior. At some point God gives us over to a reprobate mind to believe a lie and be damned.

The question must be asked and answered, is homosexuality any worse than fornication or adultery? The easy and short answer is, sin is sin and all sin is an affront to God and extremely costly to the individual in the short term and devastating eternally.

I could hide from the question by stopping right there, but I want to give a full and comprehensive answer. Here is my answer: Sin will ruin your life and damn the sinner to hell. I believe the sin of homosexuality is on a different level because:

- The Bible uses completely different language about this sin...
- The act itself is a perversion of something God made to be beautiful...
- The act is not an anatomically proper action... (Let me also add that heterosexual couples engaging in sodomy in their relationships are violating this same principle)
- It perverts a relationship that God uses to describe the relationship between Christ and His Church...
- It perverts a covenant relationship between a man and a woman that was established by God ...
- The act itself prevents the highest purpose of the relationship of a husband and wife - procreation...

God's original design was that all sexual experiences would be between a man and a woman who are fully committed to each

other through a covenant relationship called marriage.

Let me give you the truth straight from the Bible:

Genesis 2:15-18 (NKJV) *“Then the LORD God took the man and put him in the garden of Eden to tend and keep it. ¹⁶ And the LORD God commanded the man, saying, “Of every tree of the garden you may freely eat; ¹⁷ but of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil you shall not eat, for in the day that you eat of it you shall surely die. God said, “It is not good that man should be alone; I will make him a helper comparable to him.”*

Genesis 2:21-24 (NKJV) *“The LORD God caused a deep sleep to fall on Adam, and he slept; and He took one of his ribs, and closed up the flesh in its place. ²² Then the rib which the LORD God had taken from*

man He made into a woman, and He brought her to the man. ²³ And Adam said: “This is now bone of my bones And flesh of my flesh; She shall be called Woman, Because she was taken out of Man.”

²⁴ Therefore a man shall leave his father and mother and be joined to his wife, and they shall become one flesh.”

The Bible is very clear: The only marriage recognized by God is that of a man and woman in a fully committed, monogamous relationship.

I want us to look at all New Testament Scriptures that have anything to do with homosexuality. I am going to read these verses from the Amplified version.

1 Corinthians 6:9-11 (AMP) “Do you not know that the unrighteous and the wrongdoers will not inherit or have any share in the kingdom of God? Do not be

*deceived (misled): neither the impure and immoral, nor idolaters, nor adulterers, nor those who participate in homosexuality,
¹⁰ Nor cheats (swindlers and thieves), nor greedy graspers, nor drunkards, nor foulmouthed revilers and slanderers, nor extortioners and robbers will inherit or have any share in the kingdom of God.
¹¹ And such some of you were [once]. But you were washed clean (purified by a complete atonement for sin and made free from the guilt of sin), and you were consecrated (set apart, hallowed), and you were justified [pronounced righteous, by trusting] in the name of the Lord Jesus Christ and in the [Holy] Spirit of our God.”*

Romans 1:16 (AMP) *“I am not ashamed of the Gospel (good news) of Christ, for it is God’s power working unto salvation [for deliverance from eternal death] to everyone who believes with a personal trust and a confident surrender and firm reliance, to*

the Jew first and also to the Greek, ¹⁷ For in the Gospel a righteousness which God ascribes is revealed, both springing from faith and leading to faith [disclosed through the way of faith that arouses to more faith]. As it is written, The man who through faith is just and upright shall live and shall live by faith. ¹⁸ For God's [holy] wrath and indignation are revealed from heaven against all ungodliness and unrighteousness of men, who in their wickedness repress and hinder the truth and make it inoperative. ¹⁹ For that which is known about God is evident to them and made plain in their inner consciousness, because God [Himself] has shown it to them. ²⁰ For ever since the creation of the world His invisible nature and attributes, that is, His eternal power and divinity, have been made intelligible and clearly discernible in and through the things that have been made (His handiworks). So

*[men] are without excuse [altogether without any defense or justification],
21 Because when they knew and recognized Him as God, they did not honor and glorify Him as God or give Him thanks. But instead they became futile and godless in their thinking [with vain imaginings, foolish reasoning, and stupid speculations] and their senseless minds were darkened.
22 Claiming to be wise, they became fools [professing to be smart, they made simpletons of themselves]. 23 And by them the glory and majesty and excellence of the immortal God were exchanged for and represented by images, resembling mortal man and birds and beasts and reptiles.
24 Therefore God gave them up in the lusts of their [own] hearts to sexual impurity, to the dishonoring of their bodies among themselves [abandoning them to the degrading power of sin], 25 Because they exchanged the truth of God for a lie and worshiped and served the creature rather*

than the Creator, Who is blessed forever! Amen (so be it).²⁶ For this reason God gave them over and abandoned them to vile affections and degrading passions. For their women exchanged their natural function for an unnatural and abnormal one,²⁷ And the men also turned from natural relations with women and were set ablaze (burning out, consumed) with lust for one another—men committing shameful acts with men and suffering in their own bodies and personalities the inevitable consequences and penalty of their wrong-doing and going astray, which was [their] fitting retribution.²⁸ And so, since they did not see fit to acknowledge God or approve of Him or consider Him worth the knowing, God gave them over to a base and condemned mind to do things not proper or decent but loathsome,²⁹ Until they were filled (permeated and saturated) with every kind of unrighteousness, iniquity, grasping and

covetous greed, and malice. [They were] full of envy and jealousy, murder, strife, deceit and treachery, ill will and cruel ways. [They were] secret backbiters and gossipers, ³⁰ Slanderers, hateful to and hating God, full of insolence, arrogance, [and] boasting; inventors of new forms of evil, disobedient and undutiful to parents. ³¹ [They were] without understanding, conscienceless and faithless, heartless and loveless [and] merciless. ³² Though they are fully aware of God's righteous decree that those who do such things deserve to die, they not only do them themselves but approve and applaud others who practice them."

Hebrews 13:4-5 (AMP) *"Let marriage be held in honor (esteemed worthy, precious, of great price, and especially dear) in all things. And thus let the marriage bed be undefiled (kept undishonored); for God*

will judge and punish the unchaste [all guilty of sexual vice] and adulterous.

⁵ Let your character or moral disposition be free from love of money [including greed, avarice, lust, and craving for earthly possessions] and be satisfied with your present [circumstances and with what you have]; for He [God] Himself has said, I will not in any way fail you nor give you up nor leave you without support. [I will] not, [I will] not, [I will] not in any degree leave you helpless nor forsake nor let [you] down (relax My hold on you)! [Assuredly not!]

1 Timothy 1:9-10 (AMP) “Knowing and understanding this: that the Law is not enacted for the righteous (the upright and just, who are in right standing with God), but for the lawless and unruly, for the ungodly and sinful, for the irreverent and profane, for those who strike and beat and [even] murder fathers and strike and beat and [even] murder mothers, for

manslayers, ¹⁰ [For] impure and immoral persons, those who abuse themselves with men, kidnapers, liars, perjurers—and whatever else is opposed to wholesome teaching and sound doctrine.”

Jude 1:5-8 (AMP) “Now I want to remind you, though you were fully informed once for all, that though the Lord [at one time] delivered a people out of the land of Egypt, He subsequently destroyed those [of them] who did not believe [who refused to adhere to, trust in, and rely upon Him]. ⁶ And angels who did not keep (care for, guard, and hold to) their own first place of power but abandoned their proper dwelling place—these He has reserved in custody in eternal chains (bonds) under the thick gloom of utter darkness until the judgment and doom of the great day. ⁷ [The wicked are sentenced to suffer] just as Sodom and Gomorrah and the adjacent towns—which

likewise gave themselves over to impurity and indulged in unnatural vice and sensual perversity—are laid out [in plain sight] as an exhibit of perpetual punishment [to warn] of everlasting fire. ⁸ Nevertheless in like manner, these dreamers also corrupt the body, scorn and reject authority and government, and revile and libel and scoff at [heavenly] glories (the glorious ones).”

I have heard preachers and Christians quote Ezekiel 16:49 (NKJV) as the reason for the destruction of Sodom. *“This was the iniquity of your sister Sodom: She and her daughter had pride, fullness of food, and abundance of idleness; neither did she strengthen the hand of the poor and needy.”* The people who quote this verse use it to say that homosexuality had nothing to do with the destruction of Sodom. Their warped theology surmises that the problem with Sodom was the thought of the gang

rape of the two angels that were sent there to communicate with Lot.

All one has to do is read the next verse to discover there was far more issues with Sodom than pride, gluttony, laziness and failing to take care of poor people. Listen to this [Ezekiel 16:50 \(NKJV\)](#) “*And they were haughty and committed abomination before Me; therefore I took them away as I saw fit.*”

While it is true that God gives each of us the power to choose the way we are going to live our lives, He does not allow us to change the outcome of those choices.

Theologically, there is no such thing as a:

- Lying Christian...
- Thieving Christian...
- Gay Christian...
- Fornicating Christian...
- Adulterous Christian...

- Mobster Christian...
- Drunk Christian...

THE GRACE:

As a church and as Christians we are to possess the ability to make a clear distinction between sin and the sinner. We must not embrace or placate sin. On the other hand, we must love the sinner and treat them with dignity.

As a church and as Christians, we do the sinner no good when we excuse or placate their sin. At the same time we lose all influence with them when we treat them in any type of an undignified manner.

The church is supposed to be a traffic cop in society. We should be standing in the middle of the road pointing the direction to a righteous life and ultimately to Heaven.

Because the church has abdicated its responsibility over the last fifty years, we find ourselves in the position of attempting to chart the course in a crooked and perverse world.

In this series I have told you the truth and pointed to the grace that is available through Christ and his church. The position of the church toward gays, lesbians, bisexual, and transgendered individuals, and those struggling with the attraction of these lifestyles should be:

- We love you unconditionally...
- We will offer you grace...
- We will stand for the truth of the Word of God...
- We will walk with you through a process of freedom...

CONCLUSION:

I stand here today to say I believe there is hope for everyone. I also believe there is

hope for America. What does that hope look like? 2 Chronicles 7:14 (NKJV) *“If My people who are called by My name will humble themselves, and pray and seek My face, and turn from their wicked ways, then I will hear from heaven, and will forgive their sin and heal their land.”* **(LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL END OF SERVICE)**

Look at this:

- If my people that are called by my name... Not the world – The church!
- Will humble themselves and pray and seek My face... The average pastor in America prays 17 minutes a week!
Voting should be a given for a Christian but praying is better than voting!
- Turn from their wicked ways...
Judgment must first begin at the house of God. Think of all the things being allowed in churches and the lives of church people and pastors are not saying a word about it! If we are going to stem

the tide of evil and ungodly laws, the church must come back to holiness!

- Then will I hear from Heaven, forgive their sins and heal their land...

Lord send revival and save America!